Phishing Email Analysis (ANY.RUN) – SOC Investigation Write-Up

Overview

This report documents the analysis of a **malicious phishing email** masquerading as a Netflix payment update notification. The investigation was conducted using **ANY.RUN**, focusing on attachment behavior, network activity, and Indicators of Compromise (IOCs).

Objective

- Analyze a phishing email with attachment
- Investigate file behavior in sandbox (ANY.RUN)
- Identify malicious indicators
- Answer key SOC investigation questions

Tool Used

- ANY.RUN (Interactive Malware Sandbox)

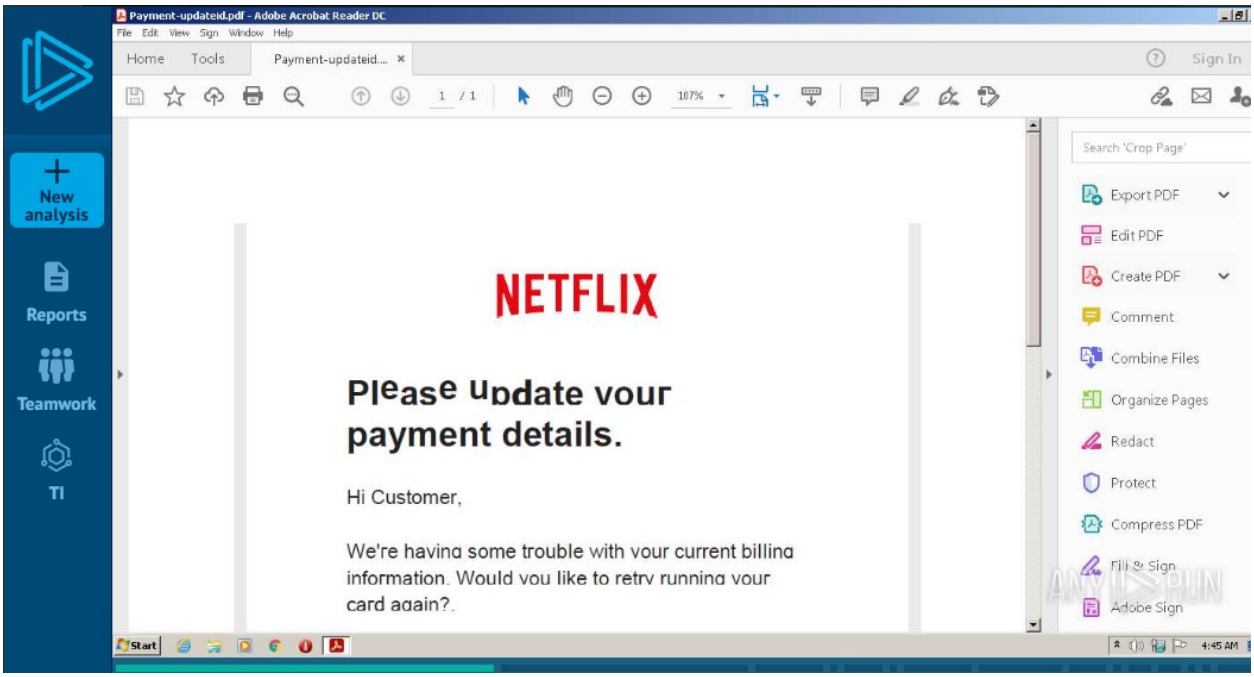
Step 1: Initial Email Analysis

Scenario:

The email pretends to be from Netflix, urging the user to update payment details.

Observations:

- Uses **urgent language** (payment issue)
- Mimics legitimate branding (Netflix)
- Contains a **PDF attachment**



Step 2: ANY.RUN Classification

Finding:

ANY.RUN classifies this email as: **Phishing / Malicious Attachment**

Explanation:

The attachment exhibits suspicious behavior and triggers detection indicators in the sandbox.

Step 3: Attachment Analysis

File Details:

- **File Type:** PDF
- **File Name:** *Payment-updateid.pdf*
- **SHA256Hash:***cc6f1a04b10bcb168aeec8d870b97bd7c20fc161e8310b5bce1af8ed420e2c24*

Behavior:

- Opens via **AcroRd32.exe (Adobe Reader)**
- Triggers background activity
- Initiates network communication
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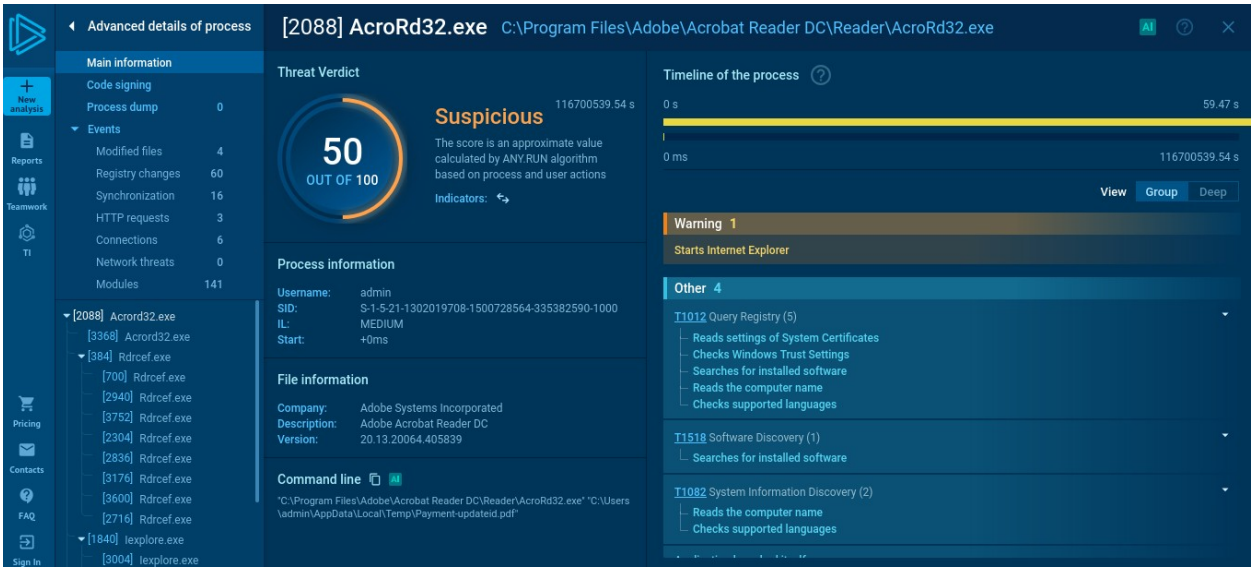


Step 4: Network Activity Analysis

Findings:

- The process **AcroRd32.exe** connects to a suspicious IP
- Malicious IP detected by ANY.RUN

Malicious IP:

2.16.107.24

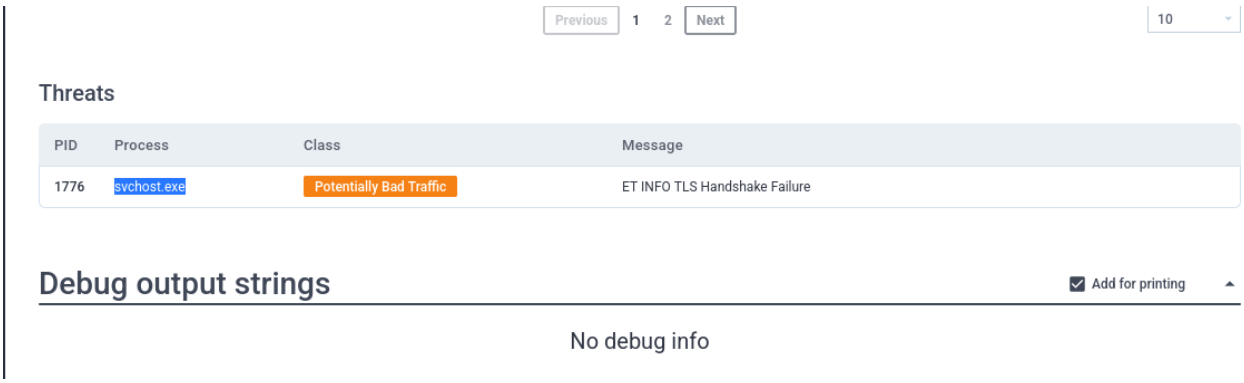
Conclusion:

Indicates possible **payload delivery or tracking activity**

Step 5: Process Behavior Analysis

Suspicious Process Identified:

svchost.exe



Explanation:

This process is flagged as **Potentially Bad Traffic**, indicating abnormal or malicious communication.

Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

- Malicious PDF attachment
- Suspicious IP address
- Abnormal process behavior (AcroRd32.exe)
- Potential network beaconing

Final Verdict

The email is **malicious (phishing)** based on:

- Social engineering (Netflix impersonation)
- Malicious attachment behavior
- Suspicious network communication
- Detection by ANY.RUN sandbox

Key Learnings

- How to analyze attachments in sandbox environments
- Identifying malicious PDF behavior
- Detecting suspicious network traffic
- Understanding process-based indicators

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